To get to the truth, you have to look at your behaviour in how you set up the experiment and see how much the outcome has been affected by what you did and how you did it. You have to find a true measure. You have to look at how things are constructed – and how you yourself have constructed your way of looking – so as to get some insight. Now, the more I looked at this feature of quantum mechanics, the more I saw that it might constitute the thing I had long been looking for: a theory of change, a theory of human-initiated change in the world. That's the beginning of quantum mechanics. I had a handle on the subjective element, which is part of the thinking behind the book you are holding. By laying out my own life, I can show you how it was we did what we did.

I began to think of information as matter, and started to examine how it flows through people and through society, and how the availability of new information brings about change. Let us imagine there is a pipeline that allows a flow of material towards what provides for a state of justice. You can look at who contributed to the flow and come to an estimation of what it was that helped constitute the state of justice. Of course I'm not talking about an actual, physical pipeline, I'm talking about all the different ways in which people communicate. But just imagine for a moment that we are talking about a real pipeline. In order to examine the way that information moves around the world you would have to be interested in the whole pipeline: who makes the pipeline, who pays for it, who maintains it, and whether it is blocked anywhere or whether the flow is hindered. Then what if we map that pipeline onto the Fourth Estate, onto the media, and how it helps or hinders that flow of information? We are interested in what it is that contributes to a state of just actions. What do we see? How can we introduce ethical reforms into the system to enhance justice? We want to remove blockages, but we also want to increase the number of observers who are contributing towards the good of this flow. If material is suppressed, we must see it as a blockage and allow the maximum number to observe the suppression and alleviate the problem. That way, we get to justice.

So it occurred to me that the Internet is a reconfigurable system of pipes that can connect these observations and these people who can take actions, leading to an increased likelihood of virtue. In the future, I felt, there would be a new way of providing an optimal flow between observers and actors. And that seemed to me to be a new way forward for societies: to make their